

THIS SEASON

To read, to hear, to make

To read. *In Praise of Shadows* by Jun'ichirō Tanizaki — the 1933 essay on why Japanese aesthetics prize dim light, patina and shadow over brightness and gloss. There is no better forty pages for understanding why a winter room should be lit low. The founding text behind everything in this issue.

Also. *The Little Book of Hygge* by Meik Wiking — the Danish case for warmth, candlelight and the gathered indoors, read past its cosy reputation.

To make. A single foraged branch in the ember vase — bare, asymmetric, one line. The whole of *ikebana*'s instinct in thirty seconds.

To notice. The exact hour the light fails, written down once a week. By *risshun* it will be visibly later — proof, in your own hand, that the year has turned while you weren't watching.



Calm & Oak